

Debate Instructions for Students

What You Need To Do

1. Prepare Your Opinion

Choose your position on the topic: agree or disagree. Be ready to explain why.

2. Write Your Main Points

Prepare 2–3 clear reasons that support your opinion.

Keep each point short and strong.

Use examples to make your points easier to understand.

3. Use Debate Language

When speaking, use phrases such as:

I believe that...

In my opinion...

The main reason is...

For example...

I disagree because...

Another point is...

4. Respect Your Partner or Team

Listen carefully when the other side speaks.

Do not interrupt.

Take notes if needed.

Respond to their ideas politely.

5. Respond to the Other Side

After they speak, reply using:

I understand your point, but...

I see what you mean; however...

I disagree because...

6. Speak Clearly and Confidently

Use full sentences.

Make eye contact.

Speak loudly enough for everyone to hear.

7. Work as a Team (If Team Debate)

Decide who will speak first.

Each member should share at least one point.

8. Stay on Topic

Only discuss ideas related to the debate question. Keep answers focused.

9. Finish With a Strong Closing Sentence

End with one final sentence that repeats your opinion clearly. Example: "For these reasons, I strongly believe we should..."

Follow these steps and you will debate clearly, confidently, and correctly.